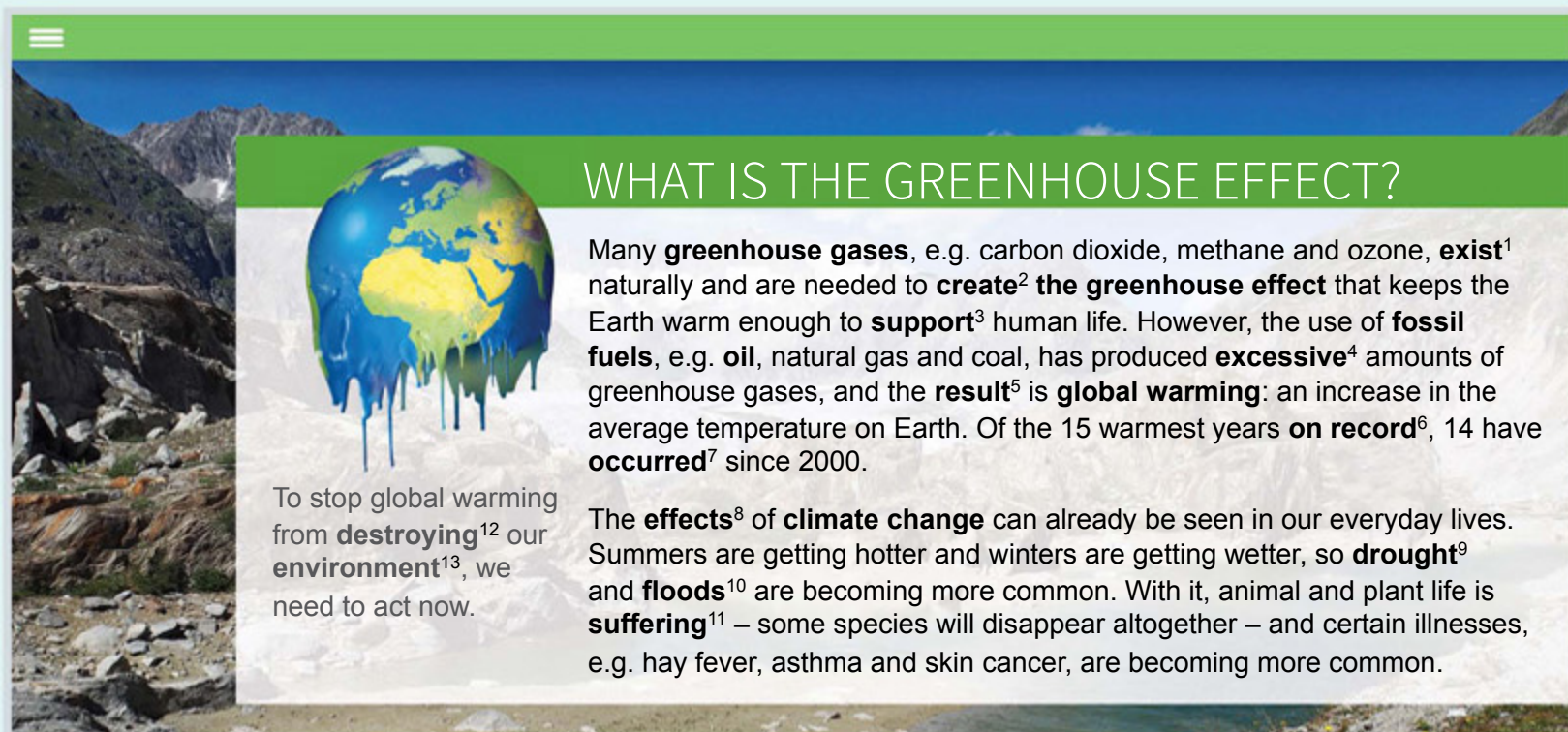


A

The problem



WHAT IS THE GREENHOUSE EFFECT?

Many **greenhouse gases**, e.g. carbon dioxide, methane and ozone, **exist**¹ naturally and are needed to **create**² the **greenhouse effect** that keeps the Earth warm enough to **support**³ human life. However, the use of **fossil fuels**, e.g. **oil**, natural gas and coal, has produced **excessive**⁴ amounts of greenhouse gases, and the **result**⁵ is **global warming**: an increase in the average temperature on Earth. Of the 15 warmest years **on record**⁶, 14 have **occurred**⁷ since 2000.

The **effects**⁸ of **climate change** can already be seen in our everyday lives. Summers are getting hotter and winters are getting wetter, so **drought**⁹ and **floods**¹⁰ are becoming more common. With it, animal and plant life is **suffering**¹¹ – some species will disappear altogether – and certain illnesses, e.g. hay fever, asthma and skin cancer, are becoming more common.

To stop global warming from **destroying**¹² our **environment**¹³, we need to act now.

¹ are real or present

² make something happen or exist

³ help (human life) to continue

⁴ more than you want or need

⁵ something that happens because of something else that has happened

⁶ If information is *on record*, it has been written down or kept on a computer.

⁷ happened; *fml*

⁸ a change or result that is caused by something

⁹ a long time without rain when people do not have enough water

¹⁰ when water covers an area that is usually dry, often from too much rain

¹¹ experiencing something which is unpleasant

¹² damaging something so badly that it does not exist or cannot be used

¹³ the air, land and water around us

B

The solution* – or part of it

To **reduce** global warming [make it less], the nations of the world will have to **act** together [do something to solve a problem; *syn take action*]. In the meantime, individuals can also help.



SIX WAYS TO REDUCE GLOBAL WARMING:

- 1 Don't **throw** things **away** – **recycle** paper, glass, plastic, etc. so that it can be used again.
- 2 **Save**¹ **energy**² e.g. **switch off** lights when you leave a room.
- 3 Don't **waste**³ water, e.g. turn off the **tap** when you are brushing your teeth.
- 4 Change **light bulbs** for more **energy-efficient**⁴ ones.
- 5 Drive less and walk more.
- 6 **Plant trees**⁵ because trees reduce the amount of carbon dioxide in the atmosphere, and so reduce greenhouse gases.

* the answer to a problem

¹ don't waste

² gas and electricity

³ use it badly

⁴ working well and not wasting energy

⁵ put a new tree in the ground